

Audion Image Tools

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A portable toolkit for images: conversion, colour, sizing, cropping, watermarks, tiling, contact sheets.

Why It Exists

Working with images splits into two different jobs, and confusing them is expensive.

The first is **accept whatever you were given**. A shoot arrives as camera RAW, a scan as a multi-frame TIFF, a layout as PSD, a phone photo as HEIC. The program has to open all of it without asking where it came from.

The second is **deliver predictably**. Here the opposite matters: a narrow set of formats where behaviour is worked out in detail — what happens to transparency, how the colour profile is written, whether pixels change at all.

Hence the central decision: **wide on the way in, narrow on the way out**. On input, everything that can be opened. The deep, predictable processing is concentrated around JPG and PNG.

Principles

Three levels of format support are named aloud. Not "supported", but how well.

level	what it means	formats
stable core	worked out, always works	BMP, GIF, JPG, PNG, TGA, TIFF, WebP, AVIF
via adapter	needs an extra layer	HEIC and HEIF, camera RAW — CR2, CR3, DNG
best effort	does not always open	WMF, IFF, XIF; PSD as far as it goes

What is available on a particular machine, the program says itself:

```
python system_core\main.py formats
```

Colour is chosen, not guessed. sRGB for screens, CMYK for print — and in each case explicitly: the built-in path with no external file, or a specific profile from disk. The program will not decide which of the two CMYK profiles you need, because that depends on the print shop, not on the file.

Operations that leave pixels alone are kept apart from those that don't. Writing resolution changes only the tag in the file; fitting to a roll recalculates resolution from a size in millimetres while leaving the pixels as they are. This is stated at each such operation, so you don't later hunt for where the quality loss came from.

Compatibility beats compactness. WebP, AVIF, and HEIF are there for light delivery, but JPG remains the one that opens everywhere, and the program will not replace it with them by default.

What It Can Do

area	about
Conversion	to JPG, PNG, TIFF, WebP, AVIF, HEIF, HEIC; quality by preset or exact value
Colour	normalisation with an explicit profile, greyscale, safe transparency handling for JPG
Sizing	to 1080p, 1440p, 2160p screens; to 16:9, A4, A3; to a roll by a side in millimetres
Resolution	writing a chosen resolution without touching pixels
Cropping	a solid border, smart white-background crop, a safety margin in millimetres

area	about
PDF assembly	straight after cropping, with embedded PNG or JPG
Watermark	a caption in the corner or a diagonal protective line, with adjustable opacity and colour
Tiling	one image across A5, A4, A3, or a roll — for stickers, with margins and gaps in millimetres
Contact sheet	a grid of thumbnails: standard sizes or your own
TIFF splitting	multi-frame into numbered PNG frames
Rotation	fixing by the orientation tag

Next

- [User Guide](#) — step by step.
- `tools\RELEASE_GUIDE_EN.md` — building a release.

Technical Reference

Running

<code>launcher_gui.cmd</code>	the main one, windowed
<code>launcher_project.cmd</code>	command line and text menu
<code>launcher_project_ru.cmd</code>	the same in Russian

The menu uses the quick picker when available and falls back to a plain menu otherwise. For short, consequential choices it uses a simple list, so values cannot be confused at deeper steps.

Defaults

what	value
JPG quality	83; presets 60, 75, 90; exact values 1 to 100
PNG compression	one preset in the window, a parameter on the command line
contact sheet quality	75 or 92

what	value
diagonal caption	about 60 % of the diagonal

Choosing a Colour Profile

task	what to pick
screen, website, ordinary delivery	sRGB
print	CMYK
built-in path without an external file	Pillow sRGB
an explicit external reference	the color.org profile
broad classic print scenario	Photoshop5DefaultCMYK.icc
coated print to a specific standard	CoatedFOGRA39.icc

Folders

input\	quick source folder
output\	results
logs\	run logs
report\	detailed reports
workspace\	temporary area
config\	defaults, themes, profile paths
system_core\	the implementation
install\	portable environment
wheelhouse\	packages for offline install
release\	release archives

Workbench Naming

This project's vocabulary is the shared one across all Audion programs: **Source**, **Add file...**, **Target**, **Reset**, **Delete**, **List**. In Russian: **Источник**, **Добавить файл...**, **Назначение**, **Сбросить**, **Удалить**, **Список**.

Reset restores the project **input** and **output** without touching files. **Delete** clears the current source and target only after confirmation. The words **Destination**, **Clear**, «Цель», and «Очистить» are not used.